



OFFICE OF MAYOR BRANDON JOHNSON
CITY OF CHICAGO

May 6, 2026

VIA ELECTRONIC CORRESPONDENCE

Michael Russo

PolicyTorque

michael@policytorque.com

**RE: Notice of Response to FOIA Request
FOIA File No.: F136884**

Dear Michael Russo,

On behalf of the City of Chicago Office of the Mayor, I am responding to your Freedom of Information Act request received by this department on April 22, 2026, requesting:

Pursuant to the Illinois Freedom of Information Act (5 ILCS 140), I respectfully request the following records maintained by the Office of the Mayor related to Chicago Transit Authority security operations and private security contracts.

Record Set 1: Communications Regarding Transit Security Deployment

For the period January 1, 2022 through present, any communications between the Office of the Mayor and any of the following parties regarding transit security deployment levels, enforcement targets, arrest or citation volume goals, or private security contracts on Chicago Transit Authority property:

- a) Chicago Police Department or CPD Transit Section*
- b) Chicago Transit Authority*
- c) Cook County Sheriff's Office*
- d) Federal Transit Administration*
- e) Monterrey Security Consultants, Inc.*
- f) Inter-Con Security Systems, Inc.*
- g) Action K-9 Security, Inc.*

Record Set 2: Communications Regarding Private Security Contract Awards

For the period January 1, 2021 through present, any communications between the Office of the Mayor and the Chicago Transit Authority or its purchasing department regarding the award, renewal, or termination of private security contracts, including contracts with Monterrey Security Consultants, Inter-Con Security Systems, and Action K-9 Security.

Record Set 3: Communications Regarding Federal Pressure

For the period January 1, 2025 through present, any communications between the Office of the Mayor and the Federal Transit Administration, the U.S. Department of Transportation, or any federal official regarding CTA security operations, grant conditions, or the Security Enhancement Plan submitted to the FTA in December 2025 and March 2026.

Your request was reviewed by the undersigned. As permitted by Section 5 ILCS 140/3(e) of the Act, the time was extended to conduct a thorough search for these records. Please be advised that your request is partially unduly burdensome.

Regarding #1 and #2, your request seeks communication without providing sufficient search parameters, such as custodians' names and/or emails. The department does not maintain a list of individuals that have worked in the department for the timeframe requested. A Citywide search would need to be conducted, then reviewed to determine which custodians were in the department during the timeframe. As stated above, section 3(g) of FOIA provides that "[r]equests calling for all records falling within a category shall be complied with unless compliance with the request would be unduly burdensome for the complying public body and there is no way to narrow the request and the burden on the public body outweighs the public interest in the information." 5 ILCS 140/3(g).

It is necessary that your FOIA request for items 1 and 2 be narrowed and clarified. If you would like assistance in narrowing your request, please contact me, and I will assist you. Providing custodians, a narrowed timeframe, and keywords would make for a more efficient search.

Regarding # 3 of your request, responsive information is attached. Please be advised that certain information has been redacted from the enclosed responsive records pursuant to 5 ILCS 140/7(1)(b). Details of the redactions are set forth below:

Section 7(1)(b) exempts from disclosure "[p]rivate information, unless disclosure is required by another provision of this Act, a State or federal law or a court order." 5 ILCS 140/7(1)(b). The FOIA, in 5 ILCS 140/2(c-5), defines "private information" as follows:

"Private information" means unique identifiers, including a person's social security number, driver's license number, employee identification number, biometric identifiers, personal financial information, passwords or other access codes, medical records, home or personal telephone numbers, and personal email addresses. Private information also includes home address and personal license plates, except as otherwise provided by law or when compiled without possibility of attribution to any person."

Therefore, handwritten signatures are exempt and were properly redacted pursuant to Section 7(1)(b).

You have the right to a review under 5 ILCS 140-9.5(a) by the Public Access Counselor (PAC) at the Office of the Illinois Attorney General, 500 South 2nd Street, Springfield, Illinois 62706,



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Phone: (877)299-3642, Fax: (217)782-1396, E-mail: public.access@ilag.gov. You may also seek judicial review of a denial under 5 ILCS 140/11 by filing a lawsuit in the State Circuit Court.

Sincerely,

Hibo Aden
FOIA Officer